Zoya Ahmer

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania **Philadelphia, PA**
Bachelor of Arts, Summa Cum Laude with Distinction *May 2025*

- Major: Philosophy, Politics & Economics | Concentration: Globalization
- Minors: Survey Research & Data Analytics | Latin American and Latinx Studies
- Honors: Dean's List, Pulitzer Center Reporting Fellow, Pi Sigma Alpha Political Science Honors Society (Vice President)

RESEARCH

Ahmer, Zoya, and Joshua Kalla. "The Cost of Voting Overseas: Five Field Experiments on Expatriate Turnout." Working Paper. 2026

"Citizenship at Work: Labor Migration Policy and the Integration of Pakistani Professionals in the U.S." Undergraduate Honors Thesis, Philosophy, Politics & Economics Program, University of Pennsylvania. Advisor: Prof. Fariha Khan. 2025

EXPERIENCE

Yale Institution for Social and Policy Studies **New Haven, CT**
Pre-Doctoral Research Fellow *Present*

- Conduct large-scale analysis of field and survey data of topics in political behavior, campaigns, and statistical methods with Prof. Shiro Kuriwaki and Prof. Josh Kalla.

Penn Crime and Justice Policy Lab **Philadelphia, PA**
Making a Difference in Global Communities Fellow *Jan. 2025 – Jun. 2025*

- Assisted with drafting the national guidelines for Grenada's Ministry of Education's drug policies through a quantitative survey with accompanying guidance and qualitative interviews (ensured representative sampling across 60+ public schools).
- Conducted interviews in person in Grenada and presented findings to stakeholders.
- Findings informed the ministry's 2025 Education Sector Plan and a World Bank grant application aimed at improving equity in data-driven decision-making.

Penn Program on Opinion Research and Election Studies **Philadelphia, PA**
NBC Decision Desk Fellow *Aug. – Dec. 2024*

- Assisted with the NBC News Decision Desk during the 2024 United States general election, to collect precinct-level turnout data from county webpages all over the United States – which proved critical for Decision Desk projections.

R Tutor and NBC News Assistant *Aug. – Dec. 2023*

- Tutored 5-10 undergraduate students twice a week in political data science courses.
- Aided students in learning R, data analysis, and presenting research.
- Tracked outlets' websites and cable streams for race updates and calls on election nights for NBC.

Research Fellow *Jun. – Aug. 2023*

- Conducted research with Prof. Michael Morse and Prof. Marc Meredith to construct pre-analysis plan to measure burden of voter identification laws using novel administrative data generated by electronic pollbooks.
- Created multivariate models and data visualizations.

HIAS Pennsylvania **Philadelphia, PA**
Legal Intern *Jan. – Aug. 2024*

- Conducted 30–60-minute interviews for prospective clients in multiple languages, including demographic information, immigrant status, and review criteria for forms of legal relief to determine qualification for services and case type.
- Collaborated with attorneys and law students to perform research and analysis for cases dealing with complex immigration issues such as U-visas, VAWA, asylum petitions, and more.

Southern Coalition for Social Justice **Remote**
Data Science Intern *Jan. – May 2023*

- Conducted quantitative research, analysis, and spatial visualization of data in support of litigation and advocacy for voting rights and justice system reform.
- Analyzed NC election data that are still repurposed and re-used for subsequent elections.

Nutritional Development Services **Philadelphia, PA**
Fox Fellow *Jun. – Aug. 2022*

- Provided on-site and over-the-phone training and technical assistance to site directors.
- Headed communication with Philadelphia Health Department about school meals and handled administrative review preparation.
- Cleaned and visualized P-EBT data, developed wellness policy resources, and created biweekly newsletter and social media posts messaging for schools and families about nutritious meals.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Technical R, Python, and SQL coding language, Adobe Creative Suite, Microsoft Office Suite
Languages Spanish (Proficient)
Interests Piano, Running, Graphic Design, Video Production